

DIVISION IV BOYS SECTIONALS

Open Door all-world against International

Lake Ridge falls to Kidron Central

Hans Schneider
The Chronicle-Telegram

STRONGSVILLE — At the Division IV district tournament in Strongsville, the International Prep School Jaguars were the only team whose photo was missing from the tournament program. And at times Wednesday night, the Jaguars were MIA on the basketball court, too.

Open Door routed the Jaguars 58-22 and the Patriots will move on to face Lutheran East on Saturday night. The

Jaguars, in their first year of existence, bow out with a record of 2-6.

"We weren't sure what to expect from them since they (Jaguars) hadn't played many games," said Open Door coach Alan Januzzi. "We felt it was important for us to come and just play from the opening tip."

And that's exactly what the Patriots did.

Led by the dynamic duo of Ryan Young and Andrew Bieri, the Patriots (11-10) jumped to a 22-5 first-quarter lead. The two combined for 16 points and eight rebounds in the quarter and the Patriots' defense was equally impressive. Open Door forced 11 turnovers and limited

the Jaguars to just one field goal on three attempts.

Open Door added to its lead in the second quarter, outscoring the Jaguars 12-2 in the period to take a 34-7 halftime lead. Nothing changed in the second half, as the Patriots continued to control the game despite limiting their starters' playing time. Open Door outscored the Jaguars 24-15 to close out the win.

"They jumped all over us from the word go," said Jaguars coach Erik Hayes. "Their intensity, execution and focus were several steps above us. They came out ready to play and we didn't."

Young and Bieri finished

with 15 and 14 points respectively. Jared Herron joined the duo in double figures with 10 points. The Jaguars were led by Earl Hegler's 10 points.

The Patriots' win gave the county a split decision because Lake Ridge lost to defending district champion Kidron Central Christian 58-45 in the early game.

Lake Ridge (4-17) trailed 27-22 at halftime but could only manage a single free throw in the first 5:23 of the third quarter. During that stretch, the fourth-seeded Comets (12-9) seized control of the game by outscoring the Royals 9-1 for a 36-23 lead. Central Christian ran the lead to 58-36 before Lake Ridge

scored the final nine points of the game.

"Same old story," said Lake Ridge coach Jim Doyle. "We put together three good quarters before one bad quarter gets us."

"We scored some points at the end but the hole was too big to get out of."

Senior Sam Maczuzak had game-highs of 24 points and nine rebounds for the Royals.

2 0-4, David Restregi 1-0-2 Totals 25-55-58
International 5 2 3 10 — 22
Open Door 22 12 8 18 — 58
Field Goals: IPS 8-39, Open Door 25-49
Three-Pointers: IPS 3-10 (Hegler 2, Wilson), Open Door 2-3 (Carroll 2) Free Throws: IPS 3-8
Open Door 6-11, Rebounds: IPS 22 (Baker 9), Open Door 37 (Young 9) Turnovers: IPS 22, Open Door 12 Fouls: IPS 8, Open Door 4
Fouled out: None

Central Christian 58, Lake Ridge 45
LAKE RIDGE (48): Sam Maczuzak 10-2-24, Moody Farhat 2-3-8, Sammie Farhat 3-2-8, Mark Maczuzak 2-1-5, Brian Vetter 0-0-0 Totals 17-40-45

CENTRAL CHRISTIAN (58): Stephen Zaccour 7-0-16, Daniel Zaccour 4-5-13, Marcus Rogers 3-0-10, Nate Chambers 3-0-6, Tyler Steiner 3-0-6, Chris Mast 1-2-5 Totals 21-9-58
Lake Ridge 11 11 7 16 — 45
Field Goals: Lake Ridge 17-45 Central Christian 21-45 Three-Pointers: Lake Ridge 3-10 (Sam Maczuzak 2, Moody Farhat) Central Christian 7-15 (Stephen Zaccour 4, Rogers 2, Mast) Free Throws: Lake Ridge 8-10, Central Christian 9-10 Rebounds: Lake Ridge 23 (Sam Maczuzak 9) Central Christian 26 (Stephen Zaccour 8) Turnovers: Lake Ridge 16, Central Christian 14 Fouls: Lake Ridge 6, Central Christian 14 Fouled out: None

DIVISION III BOYS SECTIONALS

Clippers sail into sectional championship

Brooklyn edges Black River by 2

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — It was like old times when Clearview met Columbia on Wednesday night.

It reminded folks of Nov. 26 when the Clippers thumped the Raiders by 17 points in a season-opener for both teams. On Wednesday, Clearview won by 20 points, 48-28, in the second game of a Division III sectional doubleheader at Elyria High.

Brooklyn nipped Black River, 55-53, in the first game. The Hurricanes advanced to a sectional final showdown with Wellington in the second game of a Friday doubleheader scheduled for 7:45 p.m. Cleveland Central Catholic and Cuyahoga Valley Christian Academy clash in the 6 p.m. opener.

Clearview's dismantling of Columbia ended the Raiders' season at 4-17 and set up a third meeting between the Clippers and Lorain County Conference rival Oberlin at 6 p.m. Saturday.

This time it will be for a sectional championship in the first game of a doubleheader — and Oberlin has defeated Clearview twice this season. Lutheran West and Woodridge also play for a sectional title in Saturday's 7:45 nightcap.

Columbia (4-17) never threatened Clearview. The Clippers eased to a 27-12 halftime lead and led by 19 points after three quarters. Playing one of their best defensive games of the season, the Clippers held Columbia to single-digit scoring in every quarter.

"I really thought our kids executed our defensive game plan," said Clearview coach John Szalay, whose team improved to 10-11 and has won three of their last four games. "I thought the difference tonight was just that we played defense very well. They had 12 points at halftime and it's hard to win when you're not scoring."

"We made some mistakes on offense. But I thought we passed the ball well and we played as a team tonight. We got the ball inside to our big player (6-foot-6 Jarrett Buckosh). He got his

opportunities and it was a great team win. I thought we executed what we worked on in practice."

Those opportunities helped Buckosh produce a game-high 15 points, eight in the third quarter. He was the only player on either team to score in double figures. Clearview senior Paul Williams scored nine points, seven in the fourth quarter.

"We exceeded expectations on the year," said Columbia coach Shawn Spencer. "But tonight, I didn't have a guy out there with any tournament experience. But we were prepared and we were focused. This just wasn't our night."

Black River's Pirates (4-17) trailed by as many as nine points in the third quarter. But they kept coming back and finally fought their way to a tie at 53 with 31 seconds left in the game. But with a chance to win, the Pirates were called for a traveling violation with 11 seconds to go and Brooklyn's Corey Neale drove for the game-winner with three seconds left.

"We did what we set out to do at both ends of the floor," said Black River coach Jeff Calame. "We had a couple breakdowns, but in that stretch where we came back, we were running everything just the way we drew it. But we counted. We missed nine makeable layups in the first half and that's 18 points."

Brooklyn (7-14) got 14 points from junior Joe Horvath, including four of the Hurricanes' six 3-point field goals. Black River senior John Volcansek scored a game-high 19 points, and Cory Deidrick and Adam Thomas followed with 12 and 11 respectively.

Clearview 48, Columbia 28
CLEARVIEW (48): Williams 4-0-9, Simmons 3-0-7, Smith 1-0-2, Jordan 0-0-0, Skovranek 0-0-0, Watson 2-1-6, Melcarnek 0-0-0, Weber 1-0-3, Buckosh 7-1-15, Dickey 3-0-6, Alison 0-0-0, Newman 0-0-0, Baughman 0-0-0 Totals 21-2-48
COLUMBIA (28): Kus 0-0-0, Eskine 2-2-7, Santere 2-0-5, Szczask 0-0-0, Gwynn 0-0-0, Hughes 2-0-4, Brooks 2-0-4, Boyes 0-0-0, L. Palmer 3-0-6, K. Palmer 1-0-2 Totals 12-2-28
Clearview 11 16 11 10 — 48
Columbia 6 8 7 9 — 28
Three-Pointers: Clearview 4-16 (Weber, Watson, Simmons, Williams), Columbia 2-10 (Santere, Eskine)
Field Goals: Clearview 21-44 (52.3 percent), Columbia 12-53 (22.6 percent), Free Throws: Clearview 2-4, Columbia 2-4 Rebounds: Clearview 33, Columbia 47 Turnovers: Clearview 7, Columbia 17, Fouled out: None

Brooklyn 55, Black River 53
BROOKLYN (55): Facen 2-2-6, Sutton 0-0-0, Davy



Clearview's Anthony Weber goes to the basket against Columbia's Sean Hughes during the Clippers' 48-28 win in a Division III sectional semifinal Wednesday night.

1-0-2, Gubbin 2-0-5, Williams 4-3-11, Horvath 4-2-14, Ogorsky 2-0-4, Neale 5-2-13 Totals 29-9-55
BLACK RIVER (53): Waltz 2-1-5, Sas 1-0-2, Hangan 1-0-2, Volcansek 6-3-19, Dedrick 6-0-12, Thomas 5-0-11, Rock 0-0-0, Vozar 1-0-2 Totals 24-33
Brooklyn 12 19 9 15 — 55
Black River 13 10 13 17 — 53
Three-Pointers: Brooklyn 6-13 (Horvath 4, Gubbin, Neale), Black River 2-10 (Dedrick, Volcansek)
Field Goals: Brooklyn 20-58 (34.5 percent), Black River 28-76 (36.8 percent), Free Throws: Brooklyn 9-15, Black River 4-7, Rebounds: Brooklyn 44, Black River 48 Turnovers: Brooklyn 13, Black River 10 Fouled out: None

DIVISION II BOYS SECTIONALS

Brookside, Vermilion eliminated

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED TWP. — A couple of inexperienced teams saw their seasons come to an end via losses to a pair of veteran clubs.

Vermilion, with only one senior, fell to Padua, 62-55, and Brookside, with no 12th-grade players, lost to Fairview, 64-49, in first-round Division II sectional games Wednesday.

Vermilion (8-13) put up a fight against the senior-laden Bruins. The Sailors were within two points with five minutes to go and were down by only five at 1:28 to play. Padua (10-11) made eight of its final 10 free throws to keep Vermilion at arm's length.

"We got outmuscled everywhere on the floor," Coach Kurt Habermehl said. "Every time it came down to a strength factor, they beat us to the punch."

The Sailors led by as many a nine points in the second quarter before Padua went on a 10-1 burst to tie the score at 24. The Bruins scored the final five points of the opening half to grab their first lead of the game.

"Our youth showed tonight, a lot," Habermehl added. "When it came down to the nitty-gritty we didn't react to what they were doing at critical points."

Colin Voreis, Vermilion's sophomore center, had an excellent night with a career-high 25 points and a team-leading six rebounds. Voreis scored 14 of his team's 17 points in the fourth quarter.

The Bruins will take on Rocky River on Saturday at 6 p.m. in a sectional final.

In Wednesday's first game, Fairview (10-11) had a run of 13 unanswered points to go up 20-10, and a run of 10 in a row to go up 33-18 before halftime. The Warriors never relinquished the comfortable lead despite some offensive difficulties in the second half.

"Brookside played harder than we did," Fairview coach Eric Smith said. "We weren't patient in the second half. We did some good things. When we were patient we got good shots. But we have to defend a lot better, especially on the perimeter."

Free throws were kind to Fairview. The Warriors went 14-of-17 at the foul line in the first half.

"We had a little trouble getting into our half-court offense," Brookside coach Joe Schill said.

Anthony Vasquez led Brookside (4-17) with 15 points and 10 rebounds.

Fairview will meet Keystone in a sectional final Saturday at 8 p.m.

Fairview 64, Brookside 49
FAIRVIEW (64): Kevin Flanagan 1-0-2, Mike Stanton 3-2-9, Steve Manes 6-1-18, Matt Kurz 1-6-9, Jimmy Kempan 6-9-21, Mike Rakca 0-0-0, Brent Board 1-1-3, Brandon Reece 0-0-0, Dave Johnson 0-0-0, Ryan Kerver 0-0-0, Mike Letner 0-0-0, Matt Faska 0-2-2 Totals 18-21-64
BROOKSIDE (49): Pat Balzo 2-1-5, Mark Gife 2-4-8, Brad Baker 2-4-10, John Ferenc 3-0-7, Anthony Vasquez 7-1-15, Barry McCas 1-0-2, Connor Pelco 1-0-2, Vito DeBortis 0-0-0 Totals 18-10-49
Fairview 18 22 12 12 — 64
Brookside 10 13 7 19 — 49
Three-point goals: Fairview 7 (Manes 5, Kurz, Stanton), Brookside 3 (Baker 2, Ferenc)
Rebounds: Fairview 27 (Kempan 11), Brookside 23 (Vasquez 10)
Turnovers: Fairview 10, Brookside 20 Total fouls: Fairview 21, Brookside 21, Fouled out: Ferenc

Padua 62, Vermilion 55
PADUA (62): Andy Emmen 3-7-13, Matt Jankewski 3-7-13, Dan Curing 3-1-7, Matt Hunt 8-2-18, John Toth 3-0-6, Nick Collins 0-0-0, Nate Rimer 1-0-2, Derrick Lynn 1-1-3, Steve Ray 0-0-0, Joe Calabretta 0-0-0 Totals 22-18-62
VERMILION (55): Brett Zientarpe 2-1-5, Cory Jordan 5-0-12, J.P. Kist 2-2-5, Dan Last 2-1-7, Colin Voreis 11-3-23, Jeff Baker 0-0-0 Totals 22-7-55
Padua 10 19 15 18 — 62
Vermilion 15 12 11 17 — 55
Three-point goals: Padua 6 (Vermilion 4, Jordan 2, Last 2) Rebounds: Padua 21, Vermilion 18 (Voreis 6) Turnovers: Padua 14, Vermilion 14 Total fouls: Padua 12, Vermilion 20 Fouled out: Jordan

FALLS

From C1

"He's the reason we've had the success we've had — him and Cory Sparks. He showed leadership."

Jon Dillingier's free throws had given the Eagles a 46-44 lead 28 seconds into the overtime. Falls sophomore Tyler Sparks missed a shot and his own rebound at the other end, but Nate Portik chased down the ball in the corner, found Braddick on the perimeter and the 6-foot-3 senior ran home a 3-pointer for a 47-46 lead.

"The 3-pointer was gigantic," Donahue said.

"It felt good coming off my hand," Braddick said. "They stayed back, so I pulled up and shot it. It was a momentum changer."

Yes, indeed.

The Eagles missed at the other end and Cory Sparks split a pair of free throws with 45.8 seconds left to up the margin to two, but Braddick wasn't finished. He made a steal and finally took time out with 14.8 seconds left.

"I saw that (pass)," he said. "Toward the end, they had a couple of quick (ball) reversals. One guy set a pick and I just jumped it."

It was just the second turnover of the second half for the Eagles and third since the first quarter.

With 13.1 seconds showing, Braddick

sank two free throws for the margin of victory, his 20th and 21st points of the game.

"He showed some leadership and made the plays," said North Olmsted coach Tim Schmotzer, whose team bowed out with a 14-7 record. "He gave them the lead in the first half when he made two big threes."

Those shots, back-to-back in the final two minutes of the first half, propelled Falls into a 29-24 lead, but North Olmsted reclaimed the upper hand in the third quarter and held the lead through most of the fourth.

It was Falls' rebounding prowess, along with Braddick's shooting, that did in the Eagles. Olmsted Falls won the boards 36-20 and had 14 offensive rebounds that resulted in 17 second-chance points.

"We felt the whole key was that we had to rebound the basketball," Schmotzer said. "In the first half we were out-rebounded by three, but managed to hang around. In the fourth quarter and overtime we were out-rebounded by eight. For teams like us to overcome that is tough to do."

The Bulldogs had seven offensive rebounds in the fourth quarter, three more than North Olmsted had the entire game.

"The pressure didn't affect us, except for early in the game," Schmotzer said. "Other than that, it didn't, but to rebound like they did, they deserved to win."

"Tyler Sparks was a man on the boards

in the first half," Donahue said.

Sparks had 10 and brother Cory nine while Portik chipped in with six.

Perhaps the other key was Olmsted Falls' ability to survive in a half-court game. It was a conscious effort.

"Normally we like to go up and down," Donahue said. "But we tried that against them and got beat. We noticed that the teams that gave them trouble played this kind of game. We wanted to play a controlled game and limit the opportunities."

Missed free throws nearly ruined the strategy. The Bulldogs sank only 11 of 21 tries and missed six in the fourth quarter.

But North Olmsted also missed a critical one-and-one with 31 seconds left in regulation. The Eagles could've upped a one-point lead to three. Instead Portik sank a free throw with 17.2 seconds showing to tie it at 44.

The Bulldogs advanced to Saturday's sectional championship game.

Olmsted Falls 50, North Olmsted 48
OLMSTED FALLS (50): Tyler Sparks 6-0-12, Nate Portik 2-5-9, Cory Sparks 3-1-7, Cory Emmen 0-0-0, Pat Braddick 7-4-21, Dave Pelletier 0-1-1, Scott Aron 0-0-0, A.J. Seday 0-0-0 Totals 18-11-50
NORTH OLMSTED (48): Sean Tricha 4-2-10, Jim Herold 6-4-16, Jon Valbona 1-0-2, Jon Dillingier 2-2-12, Chris Hangan 3-0-8, Brian Graum 0-0-0, Pete Taylor 0-0-0, Joe Viter 0-0-0 Totals 19-9-48
O. Falls 10 19 6 9 6 — 50
N. Olmsted 12 12 13 7 4 — 48
Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls 6-11 (Braddick 3, North Olmsted 4-10), Dillingier 2, Hangan 2, Rebounds: Olmsted Falls 36 (Portik 10), North Olmsted 20 (Valbona 7), Turnovers: Olmsted Falls 11, North Olmsted 5, Total fouls: Olmsted Falls 12, North Olmsted 12 Fouled out: None Free-throw shooting: Olmsted Falls 11 of 21 (52 percent), North Olmsted 8 of 10 (80 percent), Field-goal shooting: Olmsted Falls 18 of 44 (40.9 percent), North Olmsted 18 of 39 (46 percent)

ROUNDUP

First Baptist girls cap 13-11 season in style

ELYRIA — First Baptist completed a turnaround season with a 41-23 win over Warren Christian on Tuesday.

Stephanie Brown scored 10 points to lead the Sabres (13-11), who were 4-16 last season.

WARREN CHRISTIAN (23): Gregory 1-0-2, Tucker 1-1-3, Derrin 3-0-7, Sweeney 3-1-7, Rhodes 1-0-2, Durg 1-0-2 Totals 10-2-22
FIRST BAPTIST (41): Bruner 2-2-6, Lowman 2-0-8, Hemen 2-0-5, Ryder 3-0-6, White 3-2-8, Brown 3-4-10, Butcher 1-0-2 Totals 16-6-41
Warren Christian 6 8 5 9 — 23
First Baptist 9 8 12 9 — 41
Three-point goals: First Baptist 1 (Hemen), Warren Christian 1 (Derrin)

Boys basketball
Warren Christian 48, First Baptist 44

ELYRIA — A second-half comeback fell short and First Baptist lost to Warren Christian on Tuesday.

The Sabres (7-13) trailed 32-20 at halftime before turning things around.

Paul Fuls led First Baptist with 20 points while Sam Goodrich added 12.

WARREN CHRISTIAN (48): F. Powell 3-0-6, Chabris 2-1-5, Jolly 5-3-13, B. Powell 10-2-22, White 1-0-2 Totals 21-6-48
FIRST BAPTIST (44): Sterling 1-0-2, Schmidt 3-1-7, Fuls 7-2-22, Mays 4-1-1, Goodrich 5-1-12, Brown 1-0-2 Totals 17-5-44
Warren Christian 13 19 5 11 — 48
First Baptist 9 8 12 9 — 44
Three-point goals: First Baptist 5 (Fuls 4, Goodrich 2), Warren Christian (None)

CONNECTION

A story in Monday's Chronicle-Telegram gave the wrong date for this year's Lorain County Girls All-Star basketball games. The games will be played on March 14 at Avon Lake High School, with the first game at 2 p.m. and the second at 8